

A02 – GS4 Prototype and Pitch

Objective

You've formed your teams! Now it's time for prototyping and game/look development.

This is your opportunity to **find-the-fun** of your selected game idea and define the scope of your future GS4 project.

You've got a little over three weeks to develop the seven deliverables listed in this document. On November 21st you'll pitch what you've got to your instructors and your classmates.

Here's what you'll be developing:

1. Game Vision Sheet

What you'll hand in:

- One-page game vision sheet, including:
 - **Title:** A working title for the game.
 - **Hook/Fantasy:** "You are a _____ who _____."
 - **Executive Pitch:** One paragraph high-level pitch for the game. 75 to 125 words.
 - **Target Audience:** Who is this game for and what motivates this audience when they play games?
 - **Session Length:** Define the length (in minutes) of a single game-play session. Keep the grad show in mind.
 - **Objective:** What is the player trying to achieve in your game. This should be as straightforward and clear as possible.
 - **Core Mechanics:** Describe the basic rules and mechanics the player will interact with. This section should outline how the player moves, interacts with the game world, and any unique gameplay elements that define your gameplay.

How it will be used in your pitch:

- Excerpts from this sheet will be repurposed as slides for your pitch presentation.

2. Core Loop Explainer

What you'll hand in:

- A core loop explainer, including:
 - **Core Game Loop:** Outline the repetitive cycle of actions, challenges, and rewards that will keep players engaged. Explain how this loop is initiated, what the player does during the loop, and how it concludes or restarts.

Sometimes core loops include sub-loops. [See this presentation for an example.](#)

“Start Level => Play Level => Complete Level => Repeat” is **not** a sufficient loop description.
 - **Game Loop Flowchart:** Graphical representation of your game loop as a flow-chart showing all loops, sub-loops, actions, challenges, and outcomes.

How it will be used in your pitch:

- Your pitch should include the game loop flowchart. *Make sure the chart is readable.*

3. Visual Identity / Style Target

What you'll hand in:

- A brief but clear description of the game's intended visual identity.
- 1–2 page “mood board” that shows:
 - Curated collection of reference images showing the desired aesthetic / mood.
 - Examples from other games, films, art, or photography that capture the visual tone.
 - Primary and secondary color schemes, along with a description of how these colours relate to the mood and mechanics.
- Concept Art:
 - Character, environment, and asset concepts.
 - Shape language / silhouette studies for proposed game characters.
 - UI/HUD mockups showing interface style.

How it will be used in your pitch:

- Your pitch slides will include highlights from your mood board and concept art to help you articulate your game's proposed visual identity during your pitch.

4. Playable Prototype Gym Build

What you'll hand in:

- A runnable build we can test in class.
- This build will include one or more “gym” levels where various aspects of your proposed game can be tested.
- Your gym should include various playable game mechanics you've developed, but depending on the game, it might also include grey-boxed level design, experiments you've done with built-in Unreal features, or even potential particle system, VFX, or post-processing effects that could be used in your game.

Note: You may need to rework the first two deliverables (game vision and core loop) based on what you discover as you build this prototype.

How it will be used in your pitch:

- Your instructors and classmates will playtest your gym after the project pitches.
- Together we'll judge whether what you've prototyped feels fun and engaging.

5. 1-2 Minute Raw Gameplay Capture

What you'll hand in:

- Short screen recording of someone playing your prototype and demonstrating all the features you've included in your prototype gym.
- You are welcome to add captions or voiceovers to explain what is being demonstrated.
- Be sure to edit the video such that it's concise and quickly showcases everything your prototype gym has to offer.

How it will be used in your pitch:

- This video will be played during your project pitches so that you don't need to rely on a live demo.

6. Project Risks

What you'll hand in:

- Top 3 Technical Risks (Physics? Procedural generation? AI behavior?)

- Top 3 Content Risks (Do you need many unique environment assets? Bespoke animation? Many characters?)
- Proposed solutions to the above-mentioned risks.

How it will be used in your pitch:

- You'll present these risks as part of your pitch presentation, along with any proposed solutions that address these risks.

7. In-Class Pitch Slides

What you'll hand in:

- Your slides will include excerpts from the previous five deliverables.
- Your goal with these slides will be to convincingly pitch your project to your instructors and fellow classmates.
- Your presentation should be under ten minutes.
- By the end of your presentation we should all understand what is fun/engaging about your prototype.

How it will be used in your pitch:

- These are the slides your group will be presenting as part of your project pitch presentation.

Deliverables

Before your in-class pitch presentation you will submit:

- Your game vision sheet.
- Your core loop explainer.
- Your visual identity description, mood board, and concept art.
- Your prototype build.
- Your gameplay video. (Provided as a YouTube URL that can be set as unlisted.)
- Your project risk overview.
- Your pitch presentation slide deck.

Marking Rubric

Game Vision Sheet Requirements (Weighted: 15%)

- Game Vision sheet is organized with a clean layout and a maximum of one page.
- Hook follows the provided pattern, clearly stating the player role and core activity.
- The pitch states the premise, the promise/fantasy, and why the game is engaging.
- Target audience identifies a player segment and 2-3 player motivations.
- Session length provides a number in minutes (as a range) and states why the length fits the booth / queue context of grad show.
- The objective specifies the unit of progress (runs, levels, waves, etc) and a clear win/goal condition (“survive N waves”, “delivery N parcels”, “reach the emissary”).
- The core mechanics lists player verbs (dash, parry, place, etc) and notes challenge sources (NPCs, hazards, timers, platforming, etc).
- The scope of the proposed project is achievable for the team within the timeframe of a single-term college project.

Core Loop Explainer (Weighted: 15%)

- One clear main loop is described that uses player verbs (aim, dash, trade, etc) not just nouns or feelings.
- Details are provided on how and when a loop starts/ends, along with the actions and challenges of the loop.
- Important sub-loops are called out and how they are connected to the main loop.
- Player rewards for completing a loop are explained. (What the player learns or gets each loop or sub-loop.)
- Flowchart shows start, decision points, fail/success outcomes, and flow arrows.

Visual Identity / Style Target (Weighted: 15%)

- Visual Identity includes a short, written style description (1 – 2 paragraphs) that clearly states the overall mood and the intended art style.
- The mood board includes 5 to 10 well-targeted reference images, with each image included for a specific, clearly stated reason (color, lighting, composition, ui, etc).
- The imagery and assets referenced are achievable for the team within the timeframe of a single-term college project.
- Concept art is consistent with mood board in style and tone.
- At least one UI/HUD sketch or mockup (can be rough) that shows how core information will be communicated to the player.

Playable Prototype Gym Build (Weighted: 20%)

- Prototype gym runs reliably from a build (not in-editor) on a classroom PC.
- The gym includes the key mechanics defined in the Vision & Loop deliverables.
- Gym includes some form of challenge (enemy, timer, precision, puzzle, etc) and a rough game loop.
- Feedback exists (sfx/vfx/ui) that makes it clear when mechanics succeed or fail.
- The gym provides a simple way to recover from a fail state (no relaunch needed).
- The difficulty of the mechanics allows players to spend time enjoying the gameplay.
- The team is prepared for playtesting and the playtests run smoothly without intervention.

Project Risks (Weighted: 10%)

- Exactly 3 technical risks and 3 content risks are provided.
- Each risk is specific to this proposed project, not generic to game development.
- Risks name the failure mode by specifying what could go wrong or not get done.
- A clear mitigation is tied to each risk. (Not just, for example: “We’ll work harder.”)

Pitch Presentation and Slides (Weighted: 15%)

- The pitch is under 15 minutes. (Aim for 10 minutes to leave some fudge time.)
- All deliverables have been given adequate coverage.
- The pitch feels tight and practiced, with smooth transitions between sections.
- Slides are cleanly designed and highly readable from a distance, with visuals that support what’s being said.
- Speakers are audible and mostly facing the audience.

Marking Scale

Each section will be marked on a scale from 0 to 3 based on the following criteria:

3 – Exemplary: Listed requirements are met fully and clearly. The work shows strong clarity, polish, and thoughtful decisions that make it stand out from a strong submission.

2 – Strong: Most or all requirements are met with good quality. There may be small gaps or rough edges, but the work is clearly above the basic expectation for this stage.

1 – Meets Minimum: Core requirements are present, but several items are weak, vague, or incomplete. The work is usable, but not yet strong.

0 – Sub Par: Key requirements are missing, unclear, or non-functional. The work does not yet provide a reliable basis for moving forward.